

CENTRAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCES

ACADEMIC REGULATIONS

Chapter: Examination Eligibility, Absence, Internal Assessment, Backlog, Grading, Academic Probation, Governance Committees, Graduation, Credit Requirements, Internship and Project Requirements

This document forms part of the official Rulebook of the Institute and is binding on all registered students. It supplements, and where indicated, provides specific exemptions relevant to, the Attendance Policy, Fee Payment and Deadlines, Scholarship Policy, Hostel Handbook, and Student Conduct documents issued separately by the Institute.

8. EXAMINATION ELIGIBILITY AND ABSENCE

8.1 General Eligibility Confirmation

The Controller of Examinations publishes a provisional eligibility list for each semester examination at least two weeks before the examination period begins, based on attendance records submitted by course instructors and confirmation from the Accounts Office that the Examination Fee has been paid. A student appearing on the provisional list as ineligible may seek correction of a factual error, such as a misrecorded attendance figure, by application to the Controller of Examinations within five days of publication.

8.2 Medical Exemption to the Attendance Threshold

Notwithstanding the general attendance requirement, a student who has completed all internal assessment components in a course and who has an approved medical certificate on file for the period of absence may appear for the semester examination in that course with an attendance record as low as 60%, provided the certificate is submitted within seven days of the student resuming classes after the medical absence. The medical certificate must be issued by a registered medical practitioner and must state the specific dates of incapacity.

8.3 Procedure for Claiming Medical Exemption

An application for medical exemption under Section 8.2 is made to the Head of Department, accompanied by the medical certificate. The Head of Department forwards approved applications to the Controller of Examinations for adjustment of the eligibility list.

8.4 Examination Absence Due to Medical Emergency

A student who is unable to appear for a scheduled semester examination due to a medical emergency, supported by a medical certificate issued within 48 hours of the missed examination, may apply to the Controller of Examinations for the examination to be treated as a Medical Absence. A Medical Absence entitles the student to appear in the Special Examination described in Section 8.5, without payment of the Re-examination Fee described in Section 14.2 of the Fee Payment policy.

8.5 Special Examination for Medical Absence

The Institute conducts a Special Examination approximately four weeks after the end of the regular examination period, open only to students whose absence has been confirmed as a Medical Absence under Section 8.4. This Rulebook does not extend the Special Examination, or any equivalent arrangement, to absence arising from personal, family, or social commitments that are not medical in nature; no provision in this Rulebook addresses examination absence caused by attendance at a family function such as a wedding.

9. INTERNAL ASSESSMENT

9.1 Components of Internal Assessment

Internal Assessment for each course consists of class tests, assignments, and, where applicable, laboratory evaluation, in proportions determined by the course instructor within limits set by the Department Committee, and published to students at the start of the semester.

9.2 Weightage

Internal Assessment carries a weightage of 30% of the total marks for a theory course and 50% for a laboratory course, with the semester examination carrying the balance.

9.3 Internal Assessment Absence

A student who misses a scheduled Internal Assessment component due to a Medical Absence, verified under the same standard as Section 8.4, is permitted a make-up assessment scheduled by the course instructor within two weeks of the missed component. No make-up assessment is offered for an Internal Assessment component missed for reasons other than a verified Medical Absence; the student's score for that component is recorded as zero.

10. BACKLOG AND RE-EXAMINATION

10.1 Definition of Backlog

A course in which a student has failed to obtain a passing grade, or in which the student was ineligible to appear for the semester examination under Section 8.1, is recorded as a Backlog course.

10.2 Re-Examination

A student with a Backlog course may appear for a Re-Examination in that course at the next occasion the course's semester examination is conducted, upon payment of the Re-examination Fee described in Section 14.2 of the Fee Payment policy, and subject to re-registering for the course's Internal Assessment component if the original Internal Assessment score is more than two academic years old.

10.3 Maximum Attempts

A student may attempt the semester examination for a given course, including all Re-Examinations, a maximum of four times. A student who has not obtained a passing grade after four attempts is referred to the Academic Committee, which may permit re-registration for the course as a fresh enrolment or may require the student to withdraw from the programme.

11. GRADING

11.1 Grading Scale

Grades are awarded on a ten-point scale: O (10), A+ (9), A (8), B+ (7), B (6), C (5), P (4), F (0). A grade of P or above is a passing grade for undergraduate courses; a grade of C or above is a passing grade for postgraduate courses.

11.2 Grade Change Requests

A student who believes a grade has been recorded incorrectly due to a clerical or computational error may request a grade change by written application to the course instructor, countersigned by the Head of Department, within fifteen days of the grade being published. Grade change requests may be made only by the student concerned; requests made by a parent, guardian, or other third party on the student's behalf are not entertained and will not be processed.

11.3 Retaking a Passed Course

A student may not re-register for, or retake the semester examination in, a course in which a passing grade has already been recorded, for the purpose of improving that grade. The recorded grade for a passed course is final once published, subject only to correction under Section 11.2.

12. ACADEMIC PROBATION

12.1 Imposition of Academic Probation

A student whose semester grade point average falls below 5.0, or who accumulates more than two Backlog courses in a single academic year, is placed on Academic Probation for the following semester by decision of the Department Committee.

12.2 Conditions of Academic Probation

A student on Academic Probation is restricted to a reduced course load not exceeding 18 credits, is required to meet with an academic advisor at least twice during the semester, and is subject to the scholarship consequences described in Section 15.3 of the Scholarship Policy.

12.3 Continuation of Existing Scholarship During Probation

A student placed on Academic Probation retains any scholarship already awarded and disbursed for the current academic year for the remainder of that academic year; imposition of Academic Probation affects only new scholarship applications, which are suspended for the duration of the probation period, and does not affect an existing award already in payment.

12.4 Exit from Academic Probation

A student exits Academic Probation upon achieving a semester grade point average of 5.0 or above and reducing outstanding Backlog courses to two or fewer, as certified by the Department Committee at the end of the probationary semester.

13. ACADEMIC COMMITTEE AND DEPARTMENT COMMITTEE

13.1 Composition and Powers of the Academic Committee

The Academic Committee consists of the Dean of Academics (Chair), two Heads of Department nominated annually by the Academic Council, and the Controller of Examinations. The Academic Committee may waive attendance requirements, examination eligibility conditions, or other procedural requirements of this Rulebook in exceptional circumstances presented to it in writing, and its decision on any such waiver request is final.

13.2 Meetings

The Academic Committee meets at least once per semester and additionally as required to hear appeals under Section 19.3 of the Student Conduct regulations and waiver requests under Section 13.1.

13.3 Department Committee

Each Department Committee consists of the Head of Department (Chair) and two senior faculty members nominated by the Head of Department. The Department Committee hears first-level academic grievances, including attendance disputes under Section 3.5 of the Attendance Policy and imposes Academic Probation under Section 12.1.

14. GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS AND CREDIT REQUIREMENTS

14.1 Minimum Credit Requirement

A student must complete a minimum of 160 credits, including all compulsory core courses prescribed for the programme, to be eligible for graduation in an undergraduate programme. Postgraduate programmes require a minimum of 64 credits.

14.2 Minimum CGPA for Graduation

A student must achieve a final CGPA of at least 5.0 to be awarded the degree. A student who completes the required credits but does not meet this CGPA threshold may re-attempt Backlog courses, subject to the maximum attempts rule in Section 10.3, to raise their CGPA above the threshold.

14.3 Time Limit for Completion

An undergraduate programme of four years' standard duration must be completed within seven years of first registration; a postgraduate programme of two years' standard duration must be completed within four years of first registration. A student who does not complete the programme within this time limit is withdrawn from the programme.

15. INTERNSHIP AND PROJECT REQUIREMENTS

15.1 Mandatory Internship

Every undergraduate student must complete a minimum of eight weeks of internship with an organisation approved by the Department's Internship Coordinator, ordinarily undertaken between the sixth and seventh semesters, and must submit an internship report evaluated by a faculty supervisor for a grade recorded on the transcript.

15.2 Final Year Project

Every undergraduate student must complete a Final Year Project spanning two semesters, supervised by a faculty member, culminating in a written report and an oral defence before a panel constituted by the Department Committee.

15.3 Group Projects

A Final Year Project may be undertaken individually or in a group of up to three students, with individual contribution assessed separately by the supervisor for the purpose of grading.

16. POSTGRADUATE RESEARCH AND PUBLICATION REQUIREMENTS

16.1 Thesis Requirement

Every postgraduate student must submit a thesis embodying original work carried out under the supervision of a faculty member, in addition to the coursework requirements of the programme. The thesis is evaluated by two examiners, at least one of whom is external to the Institute, followed by a viva voce examination.

16.2 Publication Requirement

A postgraduate student in a research-intensive programme, as designated by the Department Committee at the start of the programme, must submit at least one manuscript arising from the thesis work to a peer-reviewed journal or conference before the thesis is submitted for evaluation. Proof of submission, not acceptance, is sufficient to satisfy this requirement.

16.3 Extension of Thesis Submission

A postgraduate student who is unable to submit the thesis within the standard programme duration may apply to the Department Committee for an extension of up to one additional year, renewable once with the approval of the Academic Committee, upon payment of a continuation fee determined annually by the Accounts Office.

16.4 Plagiarism Check

Every thesis must be accompanied by a similarity report generated by the Institute's approved plagiarism-detection software. A thesis with a similarity index above 15%, excluding quotations, references, and the bibliography, is returned to the student for revision before it may be sent for examiner evaluation.

17. AMENDMENT AND INTERPRETATION

17.1 Amendment of these Regulations

These Academic Regulations, and the associated Rulebook, Attendance Policy, Fee Payment and Deadlines, Scholarship Policy, Hostel Handbook, and Student Conduct documents, may be amended from time to time by resolution of the Academic Council. An amendment takes effect from the date specified in the resolution, or if no date is specified, from the start of the next academic year, and does not apply retrospectively to matters already finally decided before that date.

17.2 Interpretation and Precedence

Where a provision in one of the documents listed in Section 17.1 conflicts with a provision in another, the Registrar shall refer the conflict to the Academic Committee for a binding interpretation. Pending such a referral and decision, no student shall be presumed to be bound by the stricter of the two conflicting provisions, nor entitled to rely solely on the more lenient of the two; the matter is treated as unresolved until the Academic Committee issues its interpretation.

17.3 Language

The English-language version of every policy document issued by the Institute is the authoritative version for all purposes.